

Runyang Shu

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[Link to Website](#)

EDUCATION

McCombs School of Business, The University of Texas at Austin

Austin, TX

Ph.D. in Quantitative Marketing

2021–Present

ESSEC Business School

M.S. in Management

2019–2021

Beijing Foreign Studies University

B.B.A. (Minor in English)

2015–2019

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Keywords: Interpretable AI; Field Experiments; Visual and Multimodal Marketing Analytics

My research studies AI as both a lens and a lever in marketing. I develop interpretable AI methods that transform visual data into insights on consumer preferences and memory, and use field experiments with technology firms to study how AI adoption and governance shape user behavior and platform performance.

RESEARCH

Interpretable AI for Visual Marketing Analytics

- [1] **Shu, R.**, Lemaire, A., and Du, R. Sequencing Visual Concepts in Video Advertising: An Interpretable Storyboard Approach.
– *Job Market Paper*.
- [2] **Shu, R.** and Lemaire, A. Visual Homophily in Consumer Imagery: A New Behavioral Signal for Preference Modeling. Under review, *Journal of Marketing*.
- [3] Fu, X., Mao, Z., **Shu, R.**, and Luo, X. Aligning Anthropomorphic Cues with Content Appeals in Social Media Engagement. Under review, *MIS Quarterly*.

Field Experiments on AI Adoption and Governance

- [1] **Shu, R.**, Chen, Y., and Sen, A. Encouraging the Adoption of Generative Artificial Intelligence: Experimental Evidence from an Educational Platform. In collaboration with [Tencent](#). Preparing for submission to *PNAS*.
 - [2] Zhang, Z.^{*}, **Shu, R.**^{*}, and Chen, Y. When Safety Constrains Creativity: Evidence of AI Content Moderation on User Engagement. In collaboration with [Wondershare](#). Work in progress.
- ^{*}Equal contribution.

CONFERENCES, INVITED TALKS, WORKSHOPS

Talks and Conferences

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| 2026 | AMA Sheth Foundation Doctoral Consortium |
| 2026 | UH Marketing Doctoral Symposium |
| 2026 | University of Notre Dame, Mendoza College of Business Brown Bag Series |
| 2024 | Bass FORMS Conference |
| 2024 | Theory + Practice in Marketing |
| 2023 | Marketing Science Conference |
| 2023 | ISMS Doctoral Consortium |
| 2022 | AMA Sheth Foundation Doctoral Consortium (Conference Assistant) |

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Wondershare

2026

Research Scientist

- Study the behavioral and economic consequences of AI content moderation policies.

Tencent

2024

Research Scientist

- Designed and evaluated information interventions to encourage responsible adoption of generative AI tools.

UNESCO

2021

Research Scientist

- Supported research and analysis on child welfare outcomes in rural China.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

The University of Texas at Austin

Austin, TX

Instructor, Principles of Marketing

Spring 2024

- Overall Instructor Rating: 4.9/5.
- Nominated for the Fred Moore Assistant Instructor Awards for Teaching Excellence.

HONORS, AWARDS & GRANTS

2024–26	University of Texas Fellowship
2024–26	Graduate School Continuing Excellence Fellowship
2021–23	Recruitment Graduate School College Fellowship
2021–23	McCombs School Fellowship

SKILLS

Programming Languages: R; Python (PyTorch, TensorFlow); MATLAB; Stan; L^AT_EX

Languages: Mandarin (native); English (proficient); French (conversational)

DISSERTATION COMMITTEE

Rex Du (co-chair)

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Yixing Chen (external member)

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